

Stat 371 Practice Problem Session #3

TAs: Zach LeClaire, Lanxi Zhang. If you have any questions after the session, contact us at zleclaire@wisc.edu and lzhang699@wisc.edu

Overview of content covered:

1. Probability & Events
2. Expectation & Variance
3. Random Variables (Binomial) & pbinom/dbinom functions
4. Conditional Probability

1. Coin Flips

You flip a biased coin 4 times and count the number of heads, calling it N . The biased coin has a 45% chance of comes up tails

- a. What's the underlying sample space? How many elements does it have?
- b. What type of random variable is the number of heads? What are its parameters?
- c. Fill in the following table

Number of Heads	Probability
0	
1	
2	
3	
4	

- Compute it by hand first
 - Check your work with `dbinom()` function in R (Hint: `dbinom(k,n,p)` gives you the probability for exactly k successes of n trials with probability p)
- d. Compute the expected number of heads $E[N]$, the variance $Var(N)$, the standard deviation $sd(N)$, and $E[N^2] - (E[N])^2$. Notice anything similar between these quantities?

e. What's the probability of the event that the coin comes up heads more than once?

- Compute this by hand using the table
- Check your work using the `pbinom()` function in R (Hint: `pbinom(k,n,p)` gives you the probability for AT MOST k successes of n trials with probability p)

f. What's the probability of the event that the coin comes up heads an even number of times?

g. What's the probability that the number of heads is 4 given that the first coin flip was heads? What about if it was tails?

2. Birthday Problem

Suppose you have a group of N people. We say there is a shared birthday if at least two people in the group have the same birthday.

a. Explain why the probability of this event is:

$$P(\text{shared birthday}) = 1 - \frac{(365 - 1) * (365 - 2) * \dots * (365 - N)}{365^N}$$

(Hint: Complement Rule)

b. Compute the probability of a shared birthday for a group of $N = 5$ people.